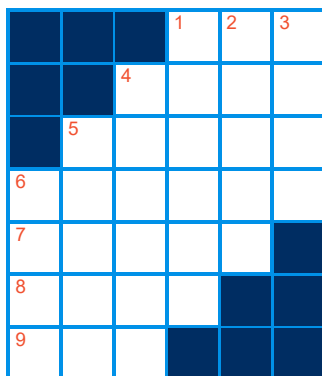




Across

- 1 Element needed in plenty for a player's post-game bath, or a fans' weather emergency. (3)
- 4 First name of the *A Christmas Story* character played by Zack Ward, who is now the CEO of a sports trading company. (4)
- 5 What a fan new to hoops, or a player new to a playbook, needs to do. (5)
- 6 The no-__ - ____, a zone too dangerous to enter. e.g. Brazillian favelas, the Gaza security fence, and Gobert's paint. (6)
- 7 Verb meaning "to happen", but could also taken as a mispronunciation of Mehmet's last

name or Cardi B's "okay". (5)

- 8 Southeastern Asian country using today's sham election and threats of Covid-19 arrests to try and quell possible democratic protests that could spill over from neighboring Thailand. (4)
- 9 Initials of the legendary architect who never designed basketball arenas, but did inspire a Louisville home featuring an outdoor court and a mural at the SwedishAmerican Riverfront YMCA's court. (3)

Down

- 1 Mythological figure who flew too close to the sun, sometimes compared to

young phenoms who let their talents and fame get the best of their NBA careers. (6)

- 2 Healer. (5)
- 3 Mountain site of multiple volcanic eruptions this week. (4)
- 4 Manatee. (3,3)
- 5 While the NBA has become a very nationally-covered sport, these kind of realities regarding Covid-19, police shootings, and weather crises have affected actual games played. (5)
- 6 Recreational non-hoops sports favorite of Charles Barkley, Steph Curry, and Chris Paul. (4)